

Ask Your Town To Carry This

The plain-language version

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · St. Albert, Alberta · 2026

The date that matters: Saturday, September 26, at noon. After that, we wait a whole year.

The short version

There is a meeting in November where towns across Alberta vote on things they want the government to change.

We want disability income on that list.

We cannot put it there ourselves. Only a town council or a local FCSS board can.

So the job is to ask them. That is the whole thing.

What is FCSS?

FCSS stands for Family and Community Support Services.

Nearly every town in Alberta has one. They run the programs that help people before things fall apart. Parenting programs. Seniors' support. Volunteer services. Help getting to appointments. Things like that.

Their whole reason for existing is to stop a problem early, before it turns into a crisis.

What is a resolution?

It is a formal request.

Once a year, all the FCSS programs in Alberta meet. Any of them can put forward a request. Everyone votes. If it passes, the whole association takes it to the government.

It is one town's idea becoming the position of nearly two hundred.

Why would FCSS care about disability income?

Because when your income drops, the need does not go away. It moves.

It shows up at the food bank. At the housing office. On the crisis line. At the FCSS desk.

So this is not us asking them to do us a favour. It is us pointing out that this is already landing on them, and that fixing the income is cheaper than cleaning up after it.

That is their own logic. We are just saying it back to them.

And it is about to reach further. Starting in 2027, the child benefits that families count on will begin to be counted as income when their rent is worked out in subsidized housing. That means families with children will pay more rent and be left with less — and that shortfall lands on the same food banks and FCSS desks too.

What we are asking them to say

The full wording is in the main package. In plain terms, the request asks the government to make sure disability income:

- Is enough to live on, measured against Canada's official poverty line, plus what a disability costs on top
- Does not get reduced when the federal disability benefit arrives
- Does not cost you your health benefits if you work
- Stops problems instead of pushing them onto towns

What you do

Step one. Find your council. Search your town's name and the word council. Then search your town's name and FCSS. You want an email address for a councillor, and one for whoever runs your local FCSS. If you cannot find them, message me and I will look for you.

Step two. Send the email. There is one written for you in the main package. Copy it, put your name at the bottom, send it. You do not have to write anything yourself. You do not have to explain the policy. It is all in there.

Step three. Tell me. Message me who you wrote to. I want to know which doors we

have knocked on, so nobody gets missed and nobody gets three emails from three people while the next town gets none.

What to say, if you would rather use your own words

Keep it short. Three things.

You live there. You are asking them to sponsor a resolution on disability income at the FCSSAA meeting. It is due September 26.

Then, if you want, one line about what this has meant for you.

That last part is the strongest thing in the email. Not because it is sad. Because it is real, and it is from someone who lives in their town.

Questions people have asked

Do I have to be on AISH or ADAP? No. Anyone who lives in the town can write.

What if my council already wrote to the Minister? Even better. Say so in your email. "Our council has already written to the Minister about this. I am asking you to take the next step."

What if they say no? Then they say no, and nothing is lost. Ask them why, in writing, and send me the answer.

What if I do not know who my councillor is? Message me. I have the lists.

Do I need to understand all of it? No. You are asking a question, not arguing a case. If they want detail, the full package has it and you can send that too.

Is this going to take long? About fifteen minutes.

One thing before you go

Most of what I ask of you is defensive. Write this letter because something went wrong. Keep that record in case they say you did not report. Appeal that decision before the clock runs out.

This one is different.

This is us putting something forward, in a room where towns talk to each other, before anything has gone wrong.

It might not pass. But somebody has to put it on the table, and we cannot do it ourselves. One councillor saying yes is all it takes.

Ask in writing. Keep the answer. And this time, ask them to carry it for us.

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